

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
KINGS COUNTY

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DONOVAN LAWSON and CEANNA PULIDO-WOLF,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER STEVEN ALFANO, POLICE OFFICER BENJAMIN DIAZ, POLICE OFFICER STEVEN LIMA (SHIELD #31540), POLICE OFFICER EVANS MAZILE (SHIELD #09374), POLICE OFFICER SCOTT REISER, DETECTIVE SHEROD MOORE, DETECTIVE PARKER, SERGEANT LUKE GASQUEZ, SERGEANT ANTHONY PANETTA (SHIELD #01600), SERGEANT PATRICK ROMAIN, LIEUTENANT STEPHEN DREYER, LIEUTENANT MANZI, LIEUTENANT KENNETH RODGERS, POLICE OFFICERS JOHN and JANE DOE'S 1-6 (names and numbers and ranks of who are unknown at present), and other unidentified members of the New York City Police Department,

Defendants.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
February 15, 2016

Respectfully submitted,

/s/

Law Office Of Ilissa Brownstein, PC.
Attorney for Plaintiffs
65 Broadway (Suites 813 & 814)
New York, New York 10006
(212) 691-3333

SUMMONS

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Basis of Venue:
Place of Incident

Plaintiff Designates
Kings County
as Place of Trial

CITY OF NEW YORK: CORPORATION COUNSEL
100 CHURCH STREET NEW YORK, NY 10007

POLICE OFFICER STEVEN ALFANO
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

POLICE OFFICER BENJAMIN DIAZ
TRANSIT BUREAU DISTRICT 33 BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

POLICE OFFICER STEVEN LIMA, SHIELD #31540
TRANSIT BUREAU DISTRICT 33 BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

POLICE OFFICER EVANS MAZILE, SHIELD #09374/TAX REGISTRY #948491
TRANSIT BUREAU DISTRICT 33 BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

POLICE OFFICER SCOTT REISER
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

DETECTIVE SHEROD MOORE
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

DETECTIVE PARKER
BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

SERGEANT LUKE GASQUEZ
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

SERGEANT ANTHONY PANETTA, SHIELD #01600/TAX REGISTRY #937243
TRANSIT AUTHORITY LIAISON BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

SERGEANT PATRICK ROMAIN
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

LIEUTENANT STEPHEN DREYER
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

LIEUTENANT MANZI
BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

LIEUTENANT KENNETH RODGERS
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
KINGS COUNTY

-----X
DONOVAN LAWSON and CEANNA PULIDO-WOLF,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Plaintiff,

Index #

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER STEVEN ALFANO, POLICE OFFICER BENJAMIN DIAZ, POLICE OFFICER STEVEN LIMA (SHIELD #31540), POLICE OFFICER EVANS MAZILE (SHIELD #09374), POLICE OFFICER SCOTT REISER, DETECTIVE SHEROD MOORE, DETECTIVE PARKER, SERGEANT LUKE GASQUEZ, SERGEANT ANTHONY PANETTA (SHIELD #01600), SERGEANT PATRICK ROMAIN, LIEUTENANT STEPHEN DREYER, LIEUTENANT MANZI, LIEUTENANT KENNETH RODGERS, POLICE OFFICERS JOHN and JANE DOE'S 1-6 (names and numbers and ranks of who are unknown at present), and other unidentified members of the New York City Police Department,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiffs **Donovan Lawson and Ceanna Pulido-Wolf**, by their attorney, **Ilissa Brownstein, Esq.**, as and for the Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Section 1983, the rights secured by the First, Fourth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York. Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested by the defendants. Plaintiff was deprived of his federal constitutional and state constitutional and common law rights when the individually named police officer defendants unlawfully confined plaintiff, caused the unjustifiable arrest of plaintiff and malicious prosecution of plaintiff. Defendants additionally used excessive force in violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights protected by the Eighth Amendment and the state tort laws.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff Donovan Lawson is a citizen of the United States.
3. Plaintiff Ceanna Pulido-Wolf is a citizen of the United States.
4. Police Officer Steven Alfano is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
5. Police Officer Steven Alfano is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
6. Police Officer Benjamin Diaz is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
7. Police Officer Benjamin Diaz is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
8. Police Officer Steven Lima, Shield #31540 is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
9. Police Officer Steven Lima, Shield #31540 is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
10. Police Officer Evans Mazile, Shield #09374/Tax Registry #948491 is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
11. Police Officer Evans Mazile, Shield #09374/Tax Registry #948491 is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
12. Police Officer Scott Reiser is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
13. Police Officer Scott Reiser is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
14. Detective Sherod Moore is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
15. Detective Sherod Moore is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
16. Detective Parker is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
17. Detective Parker is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
18. Sergeant Luke Gasquez is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
19. Sergeant Luke Gasquez is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
20. Sergeant Anthony Panetta, Shield #01600/Tax Registry #937243 is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
21. Sergeant Anthony Panetta, Shield #01600/Tax Registry #937243 is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
22. Sergeant Patrick Romain is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
23. Sergeant Patrick Romain is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.

24. Lieutenant Stephen Dreyer is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
25. Lieutenant Stephen Dreyer is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
26. Lieutenant Manzi is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
27. Lieutenant Manzi is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
28. Lieutenant Kenneth Rodgers is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
29. Lieutenant Kenneth Rodgers is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
30. Police Officer John Doe #1 is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
31. Police Officer John Doe #1 is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
32. Police Officers John and Jane Doe #2-6 is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
33. Police Officer John and Jane Doe #2-6 is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
34. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents, and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
35. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department which acts as agents in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.
36. Plaintiff in furtherance of his State causes of action filed a timely (with regard to some claims) Notice of Claim upon the City of New York in compliance with Municipal Law Section 50.
37. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claim.
38. The City of New York held a 50(H) hearing examination of Plaintiff Ceanna Pulido-Wolf on March 26, 2015 and Donovan Lawson on September 16, 2015.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

39. Donovan Lawson is 21 years old.
40. Ceanna Pulido-Wolf is 16 years old. She is a student at John Dewey high school in Brooklyn.
41. On November 20, 2014, at approximately 7pm at the Myrtle Avenue and Broadway Train Station (J, M and Z) in Brooklyn, New York, Pulido-Wolf swiped her metrocard and walked through the turnstile.
42. Donovan Lawson saw Pulido-Wolf swipe her metrocard for him and went through the turnstile.
43. The couple was approached by Police Officer Evans Mazile, who asked for their identification.
44. Police Officer Evans Mazile instructed Plaintiffs to sit down.
45. Ceanna Pulido-Wolf sat down.
46. Donovan Lawson stood next to where Ceanna Pulido-Wolf. He did not move.
47. Finding Donovan Lawson to be defiant, Police Officer Mazile sprayed pepper spray into Lawson's face.
48. Police Officer Mazile then and then struck Lawson several times in the head with his fists.
49. Police Officer Mazile then struck Lawson twice with his baton. The first time Mazile aimed for his leg but made contact with Lawson's arm in an attempt to strike his leg. The second time Mazile struck Lawson on the forehead, causing a large laceration and profuse bleeding from the wound. Videos of the incident are published on the internet.
50. Lawson slowly tried to dodge Officer Mazile and slowly exited the train station.
51. Pulido-Wolf and Lawson were arrested for a farebeat. Lawson was additionally arrested for Obstruction of Governmental Administration, Resisting Arrest, and Disorderly Conduct.
52. Pulido-Wolf was incarcerated for approximately 6.5 hours.
53. Pulido-Wolf was declined to prosecute.
54. As a result of the incident, Pulido-Wolf missed one day of high school class.
55. Lawson was taken immediately to Woodhull Medical Center for treatment. Lawson received a CT scan, stitches for his laceration, and treatment for his swollen arm.
56. Lawson accepted an ACD, satisfying all arrest charges.

57. Lawson was on parole at the time of his arrest. As a result of his arrest Lawson's parole was violated, and he served a six month sentence in Rikers.
58. While in Rikers, Lawson suffered from an asthma attack, and again received treatment. Lawson was suffering headaches, memory loss and nightmares. He was physically unable to sleep on his forehead.
59. While incarcerated upstate, Lawson received medical treatment for his head injury. Lawson continued to suffer headaches, memory loss and nightmares.
60. In September 2015, Lawson visited Coney Island hospital because he continued to suffer from headaches and memory loss. He was given a CT scan and referred to a Neurologist.
61. Plaintiffs filed a notice of claim on December 24, 2014.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

VIOLATION OF PLAINTIFF'S FOURTH AMENDMENT AND FOURTEENTH AMENDMENT RIGHTS

62. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 61 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
63. The individually named defendants who were acting in concert and within the scope of their authority at the NYPD arrested and caused plaintiff to be imprisoned without probable cause and subjected to an unlawful strip search in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty and the right to privacy under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

FALSE ARREST AND FALSE IMPRISONMENT

64. Plaintiff repeats and alleges paragraphs 1 through 63 as if fully set forth herein.
65. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.
66. The individually named defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
67. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

ASSAULT (Lawson only)

68. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 67 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
69. Defendants their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously assaulted plaintiff in that he had the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the plaintiff, and that such acts caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff.
70. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York, the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
71. The City, as the employer of defendants is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

BATTERY (Lawson only)

72. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 71 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
73. Defendants their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of his employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously battered plaintiff, when they, in a hostile and/or offensive manner strip searched plaintiff without his consent and with the intention of causing harmful and/or offensive bodily contact to the plaintiff and caused such battery.
74. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
75. The City, as the employer of Defendants is responsible for his wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

NEGLIGENT HIRING, RETENTION, TRAINING AND SUPERVISION

76. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 75 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
77. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise the individually named defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of NYPD duties

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

FAILURE TO INTERVENE

78. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 77 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
79. Defendants had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other members of the NYPD.
80. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.
81. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff was subjected to an illegal strip search.
82. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York, the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
83. The City, as the employer of defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

NEGLIGENCE

84. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 83 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
85. Defendants owed a duty of care to plaintiff.
86. Defendants breached that duty of care by subjecting him to an illegal strip search.
87. As a direct and proximate cause of this unlawful conduct, plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.
88. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault by plaintiff.
89. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

NEGLIGENT INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL DISTRESS

90. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 89 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
91. By the actions described herein, the individually named police officer defendants, each acting individually and in concert with one another, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.
92. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff was deprived of liberty and sustained great emotional injuries.
93. The City, as the employer of the defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat behavior.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

MUNICIPAL LIABILITY UNDER 42 U.S.C. § 1983

94. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 93 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
95. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, engaged in conduct that constituted a custom, usage, practice, procedure or rule of defendant City of New York, which is forbidden by the Constitution of the United States.
96. The aforementioned customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York Police Department included, but were not limited to policies, customs and practices wherein New York City Police officers arrest individuals without probable cause and create false versions of events to justify their actions.
97. The aforementioned customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York Police Department were the moving force behind the violation of plaintiff's constitutional rights as described herein. As a result of the failure of defendant City of New York and the New York City Police Department to properly recruit, screen, train, discipline, and supervise its officers, including the individual defendants, defendant City of New York has tacitly authorized, ratified, and has been deliberately indifferent to, the acts and conduct complained of herein.
98. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, and procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York City Police Department were the moving force behind the Constitutional violations suffered by plaintiff as alleged herein.
99. As a result of the foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, and procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York City Police Department, plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and prosecuted.
100. Defendants collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law were directly and actively involved in violating plaintiff's constitutional rights.

WHEREFORE DONOVAN LAWSON and CEANNA PULIDO-WOLF, plaintiff, demands a judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this actions which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorney's fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as appropriate under the law.

Dated: New York, New York
February 15, 2016

Respectfully submitted:

By: /s/
Law Office Of Ilissa Brownstein, PC.
Attorney for Plaintiff
65 Broadway (Suites 813 & 814)
New York, New York 10006
(212) 691-3333

CITY OF NEW YORK: CORPORATION COUNSEL
100 CHURCH STREET NEW YORK, NY 10007

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LIEUTENANT KENNETH RODGERS
GROUP 54 FORCE BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

ILISSA BROWNSTEIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am attorney at the **LAW OFFICE OF ILISSA BROWNSTEIN, ESQ, P.C.**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters wherein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff's is that Plaintiffs do not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
February 15, 2016

/s/
Ilissa Brownstein, Esq.